



Mobile Phones



Since the advent of mobile telephony in India, cell phones have been equated with Nokia. Often referred to as the ideal phone for India, they arguably have the most user-friendly interface and rugged build quality to suit Indian needs.

Sony Ericsson, a close second, is perhaps still lacking in this respect, but has taken a huge step forward in reliability, almost matching Nokia's rating. On the satisfaction front, Nokia was a clear winner, and it is no surprise that it continues to be *Numero Uno* in India.

The fact that Sony Ericsson has come so close to Nokia in such a short time is testament to its commitment to the Indian market and the resources it has pumped into this market.

"I have been using a Sony Ericsson model for six months now. I had a Nokia earlier, but moved to Sony Ericsson as there were more features with a lower price tag, and also because I wanted to experi-

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ment. I will buy from a company that offers a profitable package for me," says Krishna Rath, a programmer from Trivandrum.

Nokia maintains most of its followers, though. "I have been using a Nokia for two months, and I can confidently say that the products and the company are extremely reliable," says Girish Rupchandani, a student from Mumbai.

With over three quarters of polled respondents for Nokia saying they would buy Nokia again, competition will have to play hard to garner market share!

Nokia

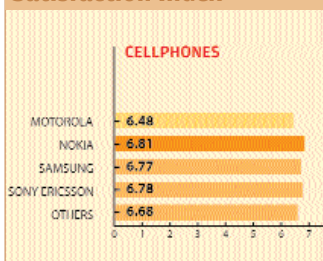
The Top Three

Nokia	8.26
Sony Ericsson	8.24
Samsung	8.13

Repurchase Index (%)

Nokia	78
Sony Ericsson	67
Samsung	65

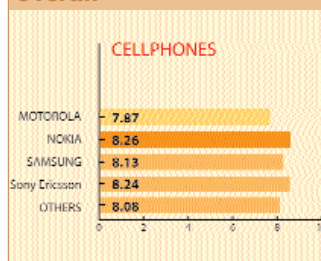
Satisfaction Index



Reliability Index



Overall



Sony



The Top Three

Sony	8.19
Philips	7.96
Panasonic	7.78

Repurchase Index (%)

Philips	92
Creative	90
Sony	77



MP3 Players

Sony, Creative, Philips and Panasonic are among the most popular MP3 players. With the iPod just starting to catch up, this comes as no surprise. As with home theatres, Sony lords over the competition and has the most reliable products. Creative, on the other hand, does not enjoy such a favourable response.

This category also sees Philips as a close second behind Sony, and with the most satisfactory service, improving its loyalty base. This, however, is a poor result for

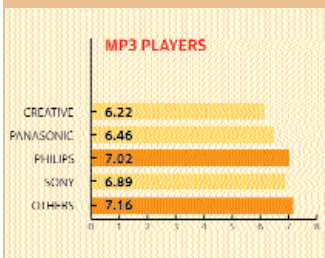
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them as they slip from the top spot they enjoyed last year.

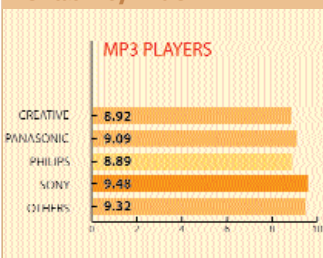
Beating Philips in MP3 players is one thing, but keeping Apple and their iPod at bay will be quite another. While ratings for Sony were very impressive—especially in the Reliability Index—it will need to spruce up service if they are to truly ward off the iPod threat. With Apple on the verge of taking off in the Indian market, next year's results might well paint a different picture altogether. Service and reliability can help Sony and Philips retain their customer base.

Hybrid devices like cell phones with extended capabilities are the new threat to MP3 players. Says Ajay Mahajan from Jammu & Kashmir, "I am using a Compaq MP3 player for two years without problems. It is definitely reliable. But recently, I also got a Sony Ericsson P910, which has an inbuilt MP3 player."

Satisfaction Index



Reliability Index



Overall

